

The people who care for our kids deserve a raise, and it shouldn't cost families a cent.

Your child's provider teaches, feeds, comforts and keeps your child safe so you can work. But child care educators in New York earn less than 96% of the state's workers. When they can't make ends meet, they leave, and classrooms close. Parents and providers are standing together to win two things in the 2027 state budget.

$1.8B

A wage scale for child care workers

Fair pay for every provider, in centers and in homes, paid for by the State **without raising what families pay**.

$1.2B

Child care assistance for every eligible family

Fully fund CCAP, the program that helps families pay for care, so **no eligible family is turned away or put on a waitlist**.

Why it matters to your family

- **57%** of New York programs are short-staffed, leaving more than 16,000 children without a spot.
- **766** classrooms in centers and afterschool programs were fully closed for lack of staff. Well-paid providers stay.
- Child care already costs New York families about **$14,600 a year** per child. Raises must come from the State, not from you.

Waiting for help

- In May 2026, **31 counties and New York City** had stopped enrolling eligible families in child care assistance because the money ran out.
- NYC's waitlist reached about **30,000 children**. Organizing by providers and parents got 10,000 off it this fall. Thousands are still waiting.

Stand with your provider

- **Bring the kids to the launch party** on Wed, Dec 2 from 11 AM to 1 PM in Albany, Buffalo or NYC: games, music and cake for Shirley Chisholm's birthday. Register at popny.org/dec2.
- **Call your state legislators** and ask them to fund the wage scale and CCAP.
- **Share your story:** what would losing your child care mean for your family?

Sources: Schuyler Center from NYS DOL data (2025); Day Care Council of New York (Dec 2025); Empire State Campaign for Child Care and Schuyler Center survey (Mar 2023); NYS Comptroller (Feb 2025); New York Focus (June 2026); Chalkbeat (Oct 2026); Empire State Campaign for Child Care 2027 priorities.

PROVIDERS ORGANIZED FOR POWER · the action lab · Empire State Campaign for Child Care · UFT · Citizen Action of New York · New York Communities for Change · AQE Alliance for Quality Education · ECE On The Move · Fight for Kids · ILR Worker Institute

popny.org/dec2

Register for the Dec 2 launch · Campaign: popny.org/pay

Questions? **Luis Cortes**, The Action Lab
luis@actionlabny.org